

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-III.6: Gospels: Narrative, Speech, and Biblical Idiom

Track participants, speech levels, narrative tense, participles, and biblical coordination through a connected Gospel passage

Stage	Stage III — Independent Missal Reading
Prerequisite	EL-III.5 and control of argument and speaker maps
Next	EL-III.7, Chants and Sequences

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Gospels: Narrative, Speech, and Biblical Idiom

On completing this unit, you can:

- separate narrative frame, reported speech, and narrator comment;
- track participants through pronouns, participles, and shifts of subject;
- recognize common Semitic patterns without declaring them meaningless idioms.

The heading *In illo tempore* gives the liturgical reading a frame but does not connect syntactically to the first Gospel verb. Draw quotation bars in the margin whenever speech begins and ends. Within a quotation, re-establish the speaker and addressee before resolving *ego*, *tu*, *hic*, *ille*, or reflexive *se*.

The **narrative frame** locates or introduces the narrated event; the **narrator** is the discourse voice that presents events but is not thereby a participant in them. **Direct speech** reproduces a speaker's words as a quotation, whereas **reported speech** makes those words depend grammatically on a reporting verb. A **biblical idiom** is a recurrent expression characteristic of scriptural Latin, sometimes reflecting Hebrew or Greek usage; calling it an idiom describes established use, not absence of grammar.

1.1 Repetition as theological precision

Omnia per ipsum facta sunt: et sine ipso factum est nihil, quod factum est.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), In Nativitate Domini, ad tertiam Missam in die, Evangelium (Io. 1:3).

Neuter plural *omnia* is the subject of plural *facta sunt*; *per ipsum* expresses agency or mediation. In the second member, *nihil* is singular and therefore takes *factum est*. The final relative *quod factum est* restricts the created totality. Preserve the repetition of *factum*: replacing every occurrence with a different English synonym obscures the argument.

1.2 Impersonal frame and result

Factum est autem, cum essent ibi, impleti sunt dies ut pareret. Et peperit filium suum primogenitum, et pannis eum involvit, et reclinavit eum in præsepio.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), In Nativitate Domini, ad primam Missam in nocte, Evangelium (Lc. 2:6–7).

factum est is an impersonal narrative hinge. The temporal *cum*-clause takes subjunctive *essent*; the main event is *impleti sunt dies*. The clause *ut pareret* is an epexegetic result/content clause explaining what the completion of the days amounted to: the time for her to give birth. Thereafter the repeated subject remains Mary: *peperit*, *involvit*, *reclinavit*. The pronoun *eum* twice returns to *filium*; *pannis* is ablative of wrapping or means and *in præsepio* location.

1.3 Participles and a moving subject

Cum natus esset Iesus in Bethlehem Iuda in diebus Herodis regis, ecce Magi ab oriente venerunt Ierosolymam, dicentes: Ubi est qui natus est Rex Iudæorum?

Source: Missale Romanum (1962), In Epiphania Domini, Evangelium (Mt. 2:1–2).

The circumstantial *cum*-clause has *Iesus* as subject; the main subject then shifts to *Magi*. *Ierosolymam* is accusative of motion toward without a preposition. Present participle *dicentes* agrees with the *Magi* and opens their direct speech. In the question, substantival *qui natus est* is the subject and *Rex* its predicate nominative; the capital letters do not determine syntax.

1.4 The first day of the week

Una autem sabbati, Maria Magdalene venit mane, cum adhuc tenebræ essent, ad monumentum: et vidit lapidem sublatum a monumento.

Source: Missale Romanum (1962), Sabbato in Albis, Evangelium (Io. 20:1).

una sabbati is biblical idiom: “one [day] of the week,” hence the first day. Supply *die* only as an explanatory ellipsis, not as though it were printed. The temporal *cum*-clause takes *essent*. In *lapidem sublatum*, the participle is predicative: she saw the stone in a removed state; *a monumento* marks separation.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Repetition as theological precision — transfer practice

Connection. Repeated roots can bind clauses and propositions even when polished English would vary the vocabulary.

Transfer task. On the lesson's repeated-word example, underline every recurrence, give each form's morphology and function, and state what remains constant or develops.

Retrieval check. Name one reason not to replace all repetitions with English synonyms during analysis.

1.2 Impersonal frame and result — transfer practice

Connection. A narrative frame and the event it introduces are separate grammatical layers.

Transfer task. Bracket the lesson's impersonal frame, then indent the event or result clause and identify the tense and mood of each verbal center.

Retrieval check. State which element carries the story event's propositional content.

1.3 Participles and a moving subject — transfer practice

Connection. A participant ledger prevents a participle from being attached to the most recent noun by proximity.

Transfer task. For Worksheet III.22, make one row per participant and place every participle and finite verb under its controlled subject.

Retrieval check. For one participle, give case, gender, number, voice, and relative time.

1.4 The first day of the week — transfer practice

Connection. Time expressions and narrative sequence must be parsed before a chronology is paraphrased.

Transfer task. Using the lesson's printed resurrection narrative, label every time expression, motion phrase, completed action, and reported observation.

Retrieval check. Distinguish time-when from duration or motion in one sentence.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit III.6: Gospels

Worksheet III.22 — Variant B

Worksheet ID: III.22

Focus: Lucan narrative chain

Use: Track the stable subject.

1. **Text:** *Factum est autem, cum essent ibi, impleti sunt dies ut pareret. Et peperit filium suum primogenitum, et pannis eum involvit, et reclinavit eum in præsepio.*

Passage ID: III.22.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Separate frame, main event, and three actions.

-
2. Identify the mood and reason of *essent* and *pareret*.

-
3. What is the antecedent of each *eum*?

-
4. Change the three perfect actions to present narrative.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Ubi puer reclinatus est?*

-
6. Write a participant chain using only nominatives and arrows to objects.
-

Worksheet III.24 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** III.24**Focus:** Biblical idiom and predicative participle**Use:** Do not turn a state into a second event.

1. **Text:** *Una autem sabbati, Maria Magdalene venit mane, cum adhuc tenebræ essent, ad monumentum: et vidit lapidem sublatum a monumento.*

Passage ID: III.24.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Explain the opening idiom, temporal clause, and perception construction.

-
2. Why is *sabbati* genitive singular?

-
3. Distinguish *mane* from a declined adjective in this clause.

-
4. Rewrite *vidit lapidem sublatum* as a finite subordinate clause without changing core sense.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Quando et quo Maria venit?*

-
6. Give lemma and full morphology of *sublatum*.
-

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: On a fresh Gospel paragraph, keep every participant and speaker stable, classify narrative and discourse forms, attach participles, and explain repeated coordination without turning every form into the same English tense or connector.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-III.7, Chants and Sequences.

If it is not met: Worksheets III.21 and III.23 remain optional Johannine-repetition and direct-speech practice.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Repetition as theological precision — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model preserves the repeated Latin lemma while distinguishing each form's clause role. Variation in English may be stylistic, but it must not conceal the source's lexical linkage.

Impersonal frame and result — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The frame remains outside the subordinate event clause; the latter carries the event content. A model that translates the frame as the event without mapping the clause fails.

Participles and a moving subject — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Every verbal form belongs to the row supported by agreement and narrative reference. The participle parse must match its controller in case, gender, and number and state time relative to its finite verb.

The first day of the week — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model cites the case or preposition governing each expression and orders events from finite forms and connectors. A devotional recollection without those forms is not sufficient.

CHAPTER 2

Unit III.6: Gospels

Solution III.22 — Variant B

Worksheet ID: III.22

Focus: Lucan narrative chain

Use: Track the stable subject.

1. **Text:** *Factum est autem, cum essent ibi, impleti sunt dies ut pareret. Et peperit filium suum primogenitum, et pannis eum involvit, et reclinavit eum in præsepio.*

Passage ID: III.22.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Separate frame, main event, and three actions.

Answer / notes: Impersonal frame *factum est*; temporal *cum essent ibi*; main *impleti sunt dies* with result/content *ut pareret*. Mary remains subject of perfects *peperit*, *involvit*, *reclinavit*; *filium* object, then *eum* twice; *pannis* means, *in præsepio* location.

2. Identify the mood and reason of *essent* and *pareret*.

Answer / model: Both imperfect subjunctive: *essent* in a narrative circumstantial temporal *cum*-clause; *pareret* in the clause expressing the completion/result for the days.

3. What is the antecedent of each *eum*?

Answer / model: *filium suum primogenitum*.

4. Change the three perfect actions to present narrative.

Answer / model: *parit filium suum primogenitum, pannis eum involvit, et reclinat eum in præsepio.*

5. Answer in Latin: *Ubi puer reclinatus est?*

Answer / model: *Puer in præsepio reclinatus est.*

6. Write a participant chain using only nominatives and arrows to objects.

Answer / model: Model: *Maria -> filium parit; Maria -> eum pannis involvit; Maria -> eum in præsepio reclinat.*

Solution III.24 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.24

Focus: Biblical idiom and predicative participle

Use: Do not turn a state into a second event.

1. **Text:** *Una autem sabbati, Maria Magdalene venit mane, cum adhuc tenebræ essent, ad monumentum: et vidit lapidem sublatum a monumento.*

Passage ID: III.24.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Explain the opening idiom, temporal clause, and perception construction.

Answer / notes: *una sabbati*: first/one day of the week, with explanatory [*die*] possible but not printed. Temporal *cum ... essent* has imperfect subjunctive. Mary is subject of perfects *venit/vidit*; destination *ad monumentum*. *lapidem sublatum* is object plus predicative participle: she saw the stone in a removed state; *a monumento* separation.

2. Why is *sabbati* genitive singular?

Answer / model: Biblical/Semitic idiom counts a day of the week; the genitive names the week/Sabbath cycle.

3. Distinguish *mane* from a declined adjective in this clause.

Answer / model: It is an indeclinable adverb/noun used adverbially, “early/in the morning,” modifying *venit*.

4. Rewrite *vidit lapidem sublatum* as a finite subordinate clause without changing core sense.

Answer / model: *vidit quod lapis a monumento sublatus erat* is a defensible explicit reformulation, though less compact.

5. Answer in Latin: *Quando et quo Maria venit?*

Answer / model: *Maria mane, cum adhuc tenebræ essent, ad monumentum venit.*

6. Give lemma and full morphology of *sublatum*.

Answer / model: From *tollo, tollere, sustuli, sublatum*; perfect passive participle accusative masculine singular agreeing with *lapidem*.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-III.6, *Gospels: Narrative, Speech, and Biblical Idiom*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. The selected Lucan and idiom-focused work is representative genre practice, not a survey of every Gospel's style.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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